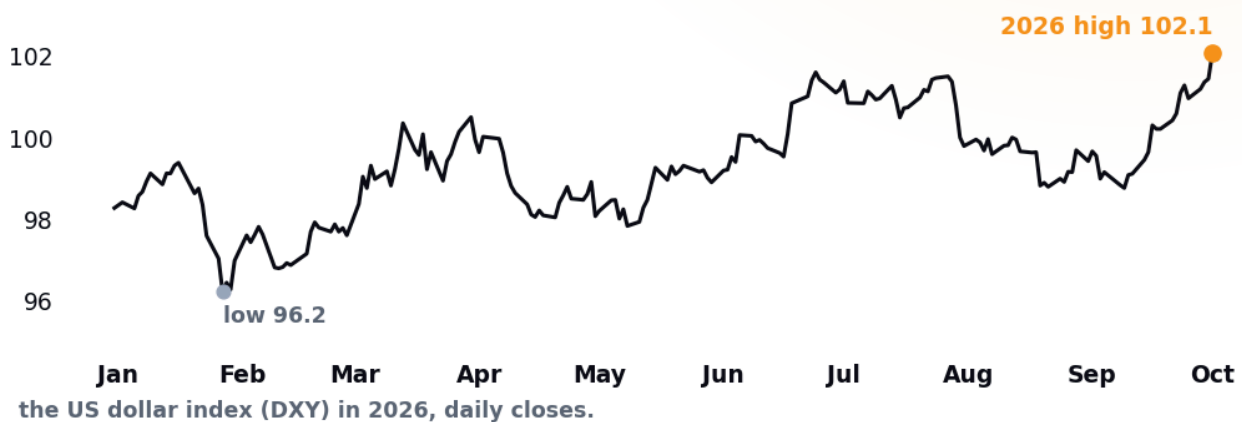


THE DOLLAR STUDY

The US dollar just hit its highest level of 2026. Everyone says a strong dollar is bad for Bitcoin. I checked every week since 2013, 716 of them, and every month, 164 of them.

How often the two really move opposite, what Bitcoin did in every big dollar month, bull years against bear years, and the 2026 months that broke the pattern.



55%

of weeks they moved opposite, close to a coin flip

12 of 13

strong dollar months red in past bears

2 of 3

times 2026 broke that rule

Educational, not financial advice. DXY is the US dollar index against six major currencies. Weekly moves use Friday closes, monthly moves use calendar months. Bitcoin from Bitstamp.



Bitcoin Jae
@bitcoin.daily

THE EVERYDAY LINK

MOSTLY A COIN FLIP



	WEEKS MOVED OPPOSITE	MONTHS MOVED OPPOSITE	WEEKLY CORRELATION
Every year	395/716 (55%)	88/164 (54%)	-0.08
Bull years	246/469 (52%)	57/107 (53%)	-0.07
Bear years	149/247 (60%)	31/57 (54%)	-0.07

Correlation runs from -1 (perfect opposites) to +1 (move together). 0 means no link.

Week to week and month to month, Bitcoin and the dollar moved in opposite directions only a little more than half the time. The rolling one-year correlation has stayed between -0.40 and +0.25 since 2014 and was below -0.3 only 2% of the time. On an ordinary week, the dollar tells you very little about Bitcoin.

YEAR BY YEAR

EVERY YEAR, WEEKLY

YEAR	WEEKS MOVED OPPOSITE	WEEKLY CORRELATION
2013	23/51 (45%)	+0.02
2014	31/52 (60%)	-0.10
2015	27/52 (52%)	+0.15
2016	30/53 (57%)	-0.17
2017	20/52 (38%)	+0.22
2018	35/52 (67%)	-0.23
2019	31/52 (60%)	-0.24
2020	32/52 (62%)	-0.28
2021	25/53 (47%)	-0.09
2022	36/52 (69%)	-0.14
2023	31/52 (60%)	-0.18
2024	22/52 (42%)	+0.01
2025	32/52 (62%)	-0.24
2026	20/39 (51%)	-0.19

2026 runs to 30 September.

The link was strongest in 2018 to 2020 and in 2025, when the correlation sat near -0.25. Even then, a third of weeks or more moved the same way. In 2017 and 2024, two big bull years, the two mostly moved together.

BIG DOLLAR MONTHS

WHEN THE DOLLAR JUMPS

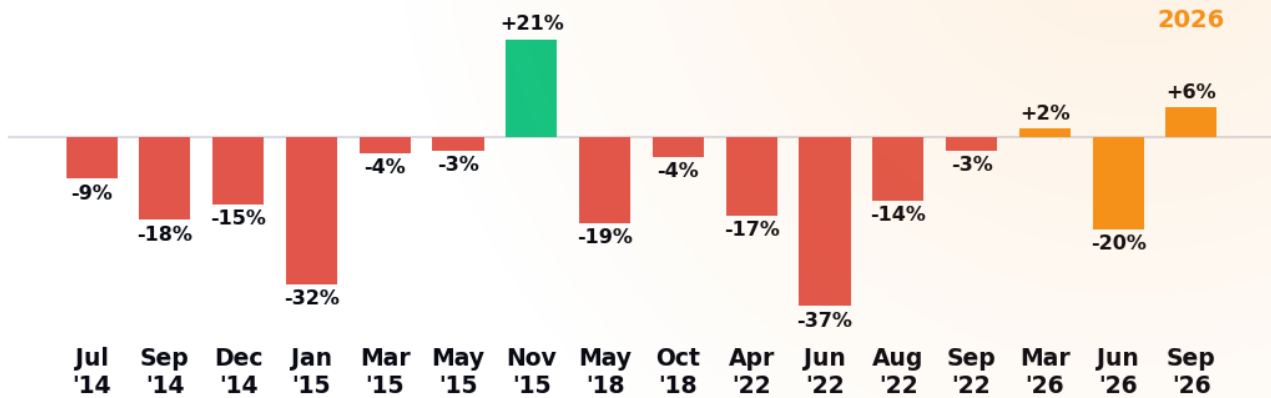
DOLLAR'S MONTH	MONTHS	BITCOIN GREEN	TYPICAL BITCOIN MONTH	GREEN IN BEAR YEARS
Dollar up 2% or more	31	12/31 (39%)	-3.6%	3/16 (19%)
Dollar within 2%	110	66/110 (60%)	+6.9%	20/37 (54%)
Dollar down 2% or more	23	12/23 (52%)	+2.4%	0/4 (0%)

Typical = median. All months January 2013 to September 2026.

The link shows up at the extremes. When the dollar rose 2% or more in a month, Bitcoin was green only 39% of the time and the typical month was red. A falling dollar was not the rescue it is made out to be, green about half the time and never in a bear year. Bitcoin's best months came when the dollar was quiet.

IN A BEAR

A STRONG DOLLAR IN A BEAR



Bitcoin's month, every time the dollar rose 2%+ in a month during a bear year.

MONTH	DOLLAR	BITCOIN
Jul 2014	+2.1%	-9.2%
Sep 2014	+3.9%	-18.4%
Dec 2014	+2.2%	-14.9%
Jan 2015	+5.0%	-32.4%
Mar 2015	+3.3%	-3.6%
May 2015	+2.4%	-3.1%
Nov 2015	+3.3%	+21.4%
May 2018	+2.3%	-18.9%
Oct 2018	+2.0%	-4.5%
Apr 2022	+4.7%	-17.3%
Jun 2022	+2.9%	-37.3%
Aug 2022	+2.6%	-14.0%
Sep 2022	+3.1%	-3.2%
Mar 2026	+2.4%	+1.8%
Jun 2026	+2.3%	-20.4%
Sep 2026	+2.0%	+6.4%

Before 2026, a +2% dollar month in a bear year left Bitcoin red 12 times out of 13. The one exception, November 2015, came ten months after that bear's final low. In 2026 the rule broke twice in three tries, March and September.

NOW

WHERE THE DOLLAR STANDS

2026	DOLLAR	BITCOIN
January	-1.3%	-10.1%
February	+0.6%	-14.8%
March	+2.4%	+1.8%
April	-1.9%	+11.9%
May	+0.8%	-3.6%
June	+2.3%	-20.4%
July	-1.4%	+7.3%
August	-0.4%	+25.1%
September	+2.0%	+6.4%

Monthly moves, calendar months.

The dollar index started 2026 at 98.3, fell to 96.2 in late January and closed at 102.1 on 1 October, its highest close of the year, up 3.7%. September was a +2% dollar month and Bitcoin still rose 6.4%.

What to watch. Most weeks, ignore the dollar. Watch it when it jumps 2% or more in a month. If that happens again in October, it is the clearest test yet of whether this bear still follows the old rule.

The limits. 164 months is a modest sample and the bear-year cuts are smaller still, 16 strong dollar months and 4 weak ones. Correlation is not cause. The dollar and Bitcoin both react to the same things, rates, liquidity and risk appetite, and that shared driver is most of what this measures.

Data pinned 2 October 2026. Bitstamp BTC/USD, Yahoo DX-Y.NYB. Scripts: DXY/dxy_study.py, DXY/dxy_charts.py. This is education, not financial advice.

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